

Copilot Studio Governance Baseline

A sequenced planning reference for Microsoft 365 Copilot and Copilot Studio agents: ownership and data boundaries, delivery, publishing, evidence, and consumption.

Start before build

Personal, read-only productivity agents can use a low-risk lane. Shared, action-taking, or mission-critical agents can use an IT-managed lifecycle. Each organization defines its classifications, approvals, ownership fields, and review cadence.

PHASE 1 | FOUNDATION Establish control

- 1 Classify and assign owners**
Classify personal, departmental, or mission-critical use. Record the business owner, technical owner, backup owner, support contact, audience, risk, cost center, and next review date. [Governance zones >](#)
- 2 Create lifecycle environments**
Use separate development, test, and production environments for shared agents. Attach Microsoft Entra security groups, assign least-privilege roles through group teams, and keep production authoring access small. [Environment strategy >](#)
- 3 Enforce DLP and identity**
Microsoft Entra authentication and data policies can govern knowledge types, connectors and tools, HTTP, skills, and channels. Endpoint filtering is preview and should be verified in GCC. Test policy enforcement before publishing. [Configure data policies >](#)

PHASE 2 | DELIVERY Release safely

- 4 Review data and connections**
Correct SharePoint permissions before connecting a site. Record each source, endpoint, connection identity, secret, third-party processor, and residency exception. Prefer user-context access and least-privilege identities. [SharePoint knowledge access >](#)
- 5 Standardize build and test**
Require scoped instructions, approved tools, safe failure behavior, expected outcomes, abuse cases, a human or support path, and test evidence. Validate with limited users before production review. [Test your agent >](#)
- 6 Promote with controlled ALM**
Custom solutions move agents between environments. Review required objects before export and reconfigure target-specific components and authentication after import. PAC CLI and Azure DevOps Build Tools support GCC. [Solutions and ALM >](#)

PHASE 3 | OPERATIONS Publish and sustain

- 7 Gate sharing and publishing**
Separate Editor from Viewer access and share only with approved groups. Require owner, security/data, test, support, and funding approval. GCC organization-wide Teams and Microsoft 365 publication uses admin submission. [Share agents safely >](#)
- 8 Monitor, retain, and respond**
In supported Dataverse environments, settings control transcript saving and owner/editor access; Power Apps viewing also requires Bot Transcript Viewer. M365 Copilot agents don't write to this table. Purview controls are available in GCC subject to licensing. [Transcript controls >](#)
- 9 Fund, meter, and review**
Document a capacity owner, cost center, and chosen funding path for each production environment. PAYG and newer capacity controls should be verified in the target GCC tenant. [Billing configuration guide >](#)

Example organization-defined production gate

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|------------------------------|------------------------------|-----------------------------|--------------------------------|
| ✓ Primary and backup owners | ✓ Approved audience and risk | ✓ Entra authentication | ✓ DLP policy passes |
| ✓ Versioned solution release | ✓ Security and UAT evidence | ✓ Support and incident path | ✓ Funding and overage decision |

Billing and capacity reference | Verify conditional controls in the target GCC tenant.

Copilot Studio billing paths, allocation options, overage behavior, and Azure cost alerts are explained in the [Copilot Studio Billing Configuration Guide >](#)

[GCC service description](#) · [Agent data policies](#) · [Security guidance](#) · [Solutions and ALM](#) · [Transcript controls](#) · [Capacity controls](#) · [Billing configuration guide](#)

Reference baseline. Based on public Microsoft documentation as of **July 23, 2026** for GCC, not GCC High or DoD. Availability, licensing, release timing, and controls can vary by tenant and configuration. Validate conditional features in the target GCC tenant; official Microsoft terms and documentation control.